Moreno Mancosu

Curriculum Vitae

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Scientific Positions

Since 2022 **Associate Professor**, *University of Turin, Italy*

Since 2021 **Affiliate**, *Collegio Carlo Alberto, Italy*

2019-2022 **Assistant Professor**, *University of Turin, Italy*

2019 **Post-doctoral fellow**, *Horizon 2020 project*, DEMOS: Democratic Efficacy and the Varieties of Populism in Europe, *University of Turin, Italy*

Jun 2017 **Visiting Graduate Scholar**, Southern Denmark University, Department of Political Science, *Sponsor: David N. Hopmann*

2015-2019 **Post-Doctoral Fellow**, Collegio Carlo Alberto, *Turin, Italy*

Apr/Jun 2014 **Visiting Graduate Scholar**, University of California - Los Angeles, Department of Geography, *Sponsor: Michael E. Shin*

2010-2014 **Research Associate**, *Cost action IS0806*, The True European Voter, *Action Chairs: Hermann Schmitt, Paolo Segatti*

Higher Education

2010-2015 **Ph.D. - Sociology and Social Research**, University of Trento, *Advisor:* Cristiano Vezzoni

2007-2010 **MA**, *Sociology and Social Research*, *University of Trento*, Grade: Magna cum laude

2004-2007 **BA**, *Sociology*, *University of Milan-Bicocca*

Selected awards and third party funding

2023 **PRIN - Research Projects of National Relevance**, Proposal title: SUSPECTS - StUdying Support, demand, and Endorsement of Conspiracy TheorieS in six European countries (€ 273.766 - PI), *Ministry of University - Italy*

2023 **PRIN - Research Projects of National Relevance**, Proposal title: ECHO-BIT - Echo CHambers, Opinions and Behaviors in Italy (€ 239085 - Unito Unit PI), *Ministry of University - Italy*

2022 **Grant for internationalization**, Proposal title: Experiments in Democracy (€ 30.000 - Proposal with Massimiliano Demata), *University of Turin, Italy*

2018 **Collegio Carlo Alberto co-funding grant.**, Proposal title: ITANES (Italian National Election Study) pre-election RCS wave (€ 10.000 - Proposal with Giuliano Bobba), *Collegio Carlo Alberto, Italy*

2016 **Best Ph.D. thesis**, *University of Trento, Italy*

2013 **4th year PhD grant from**, School of Social Sciences committee - University of Trento, *Italy*

Peer-reviewed articles

[46] Fiore, E., Mancosu, M. & Pessina, G. (2025). Perceptions of Jewish and Israelis in Italy: Evidence from a Survey Experiment on Political Orientation. Partecipazione e Conflitto. 18(3). 1-29.

[45] Mancosu, M., & Sarcone, G. (2025). Immigration, Place, and the Right: Explaining Support for the Radical Right in Italy during 2022 Italian National Elections. Regional Science Policy & Practice, EarlyView

[44] Decadri, S., Mancosu, M., Negri, F., & Scaduto, G. (2025). Aligning Emotions: A Comparative Analysis of Text and Imagery by European Party Leaders on Instagram. The International Journal of Press/Politics, EarlyView.

[43] Vegetti, F., Mancosu, M. (2025). Perceived exposure and concern for misinformation in context: Evidence from 27 European countries. American Behavioral Scientist. 69 (2), 131-147.

[42] Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Nai, A., Seddone, A., & Vegetti, F. (2025). Investigating Media Populism Worldwide. Journalism Studies, 26(2), 181-199.

[41] Biancalana, C., & Mancosu, M. (2025). Is the public legitimacy of protests rooted in the political context? An experimental study comparing protests by environmentalists and farmers. Italian Political Science Review/Rivista Italiana di Scienza Politica, EarlyView.

[40] Mancosu, M., Vegetti, F., Seddone, A., & Bobba, G. (2024). Perceived victimhood in Italian politics: political ideology, populism, and economic grievance. South European Society and Politics, 29(2), 159-180.

[39] Mancosu, M., Scaduto, G. (2024) Crowds and Smiles: Visual Opportunity Structures and the Communication of European Political Leaders During the COVID-19 Pandemic. 28 (4), 632-657.

[38] Ramella, F., Mancosu, M. (2023) La generazione dello sperimentalismo democratico. Il Mulino, 72(4), 68-76.

[37] Scaduto, G., Mancosu, M. (2022). Lacrime di coccodrillo? Variazioni nel contenuto visuale su Instagram dei politici populisti e mainstream durante la pandemia. Comunicazione Politica, 23(2), 255–276.

[36] Mancosu, M., Seddone, A., Bobba, G. (2022). Negativity in the news and electoral behavior between first-and second-order elections. Italian Political Science Review/Rivista Italiana Di Scienza Politica, 52(3), 391–403.

[35] Mancosu, M., Vassallo, S. (2022). The life cycle of conspiracy theories: evidence from a long-term panel survey on conspiracy beliefs in Italy. Italian Political Science Review/Rivista Italiana Di Scienza Politica, 52(1), 1–17.

[34] Mancosu, M., Seddone, A., Bobba, G., Vegetti, F., Others. (2021). "In conspiracies we trust": interpersonal/institutional trust and beliefs in conspiracy theories during the COVID-19 pandemic. Italian Political Science, 16(2), 1–15.

[33] Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Roncarolo, F., Seddone, A., Vegetti, F. (2021). Losers get sick? The effects of electoral defeat on perceptions of pandemic risk. Quaderni Dell'Osservatorio Elettorale QOE-IJES, 84(2), 79–91.

[32] Mancosu, M., Seddone, A., Bobba, G., Cremonesi, C., Mancini, P., Roncarolo, F., Legnante, G. (2021). How Do Ëasyänd "Tough"Media Shape Candidates' Evaluation? Effects of Visibility and Tone on Voters during the Election Campaign. Comunicazione Politica, 22(1), 47–78.

[31] Mancosu, M., Vegetti, F. (2021). "Is it the message or the messenger?": Conspiracy endorsement and media sources. Social Science Computer Review, 39(6), 1203–1217.

[30] Mancosu, M., Ladini, R., Vassallo, S. (2021). Political consequences of conspiratorial thinking: evidence from 2016 Italian constitutional referendum. Acta Politica, 56, 69–88.

[29] Mancosu, M., Ferrin Pereira, M. (2021). Terrorist attacks, stereotyping, and attitudes toward immigrants: the case of the manchester bombing. Social Science Quarterly, 102(1), 420–432.

[28] Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A., Vegetti, F. (2020). Il Barometro dell'Odio nello Sport. L'hate speech online nelle conversazioni sportive su Facebook e Twitter. Problemi Dell'informazione, 45(2), 313–318.

[27] Mancosu, M., Vegetti, F. (2020). What you can scrape and what is right to scrape: A proposal for a tool to collect public Facebook data. Social Media+ Society, 6(3), 2056305120940703.

[26] Vegetti, F., Mancosu, M. (2020). The impact of political sophistication and motivated reasoning on misinformation. Political Communication, 37(5), 678–695.

[25] Ladini, R., Mancosu, M., Vezzoni, C. (2020). Electoral participation, disagreement, and diversity in social networks: A matter of intimacy? Communication Research, 47(7), 1056–1078.

[24] Ferrín, M., Mancosu, M., Cappiali, T. M. (2020). Terrorist attacks and Europeans' attitudes towards immigrants: An experimental approach. European Journal of Political Research, 59(3), 491–516.

[23] Quaranta, M., Mancosu, M., Martini, S. (2020). A tale of bias: Longitudinal evidence of the effect of electoral defeat on citizens' evaluations of the economy. International Journal of Public Opinion Research, 32(3), 604–620.

[22] Mancosu, M., Ladini, R. (2020). The red and the black: neo-fascist inheritance in the electoral success of the Lega in Tuscany, Umbria, and Marche. Journal of Modern Italian Studies, 25(2), 197–216.

[21] Mancosu, M.. (2019). Contextual effects, awareness, and voting behaviour: Does knowing about local politics increase contextual influence? Politics, 39(3), 315–331.

[20] Mancosu, M., Ladini, R. (2019). The neo-fascist territorial legacy and the success of the Lega in the 2019 European elections: a multilevel approach. Italian Political Science, 14(2), 114–128.

[19] Cremonesi, C., Seddone, A., Bobba, G., Mancosu, M. (2019). The European Union in the media coverage of the 2019 European election campaign in Italy: towards the Europeanization of the Italian public sphere. Journal of Modern Italian Studies, 24(5), 668–690.

[18] Mancosu, M., Ladini, R., Vezzoni, C. (2019). 'Short is better'. Evaluating the attentiveness of online respondents through screener questions in a real survey environment. Bulletin of Sociological Methodology/Bulletin de Méthodologie Sociologique, 141(1), 30–45.

[17] Cremonesi, C., Bobba, G., Legnante, G., Mancosu, M., Roncarolo, F., Seddone, A. (2019). Political information exposure and populist attitudes in the "Laboratory of Populism". An exploratory analysis of the 2018 Italian general election campaign. Comunicazione Politica, 20(1), 39–62.

[16] Mancosu, M.. (2019). Interpersonal communication, voting behavior and influence in election campaigns: a directional approach. Quality & Quantity, 53, 2917–2932.

[15] Mancosu, M., Hopmann, D. N. (2019). Political disagreement and vote volatility: the role of familism across different European countries. European Political Science Review, 11(3), 301–317.

[14] Mancosu, M., Bobba, G. (2019). Using deep-learning algorithms to derive basic characteristics of social media users: The Brexit campaign as a case study. Plos One, 14(1), e0211013.

[13] Mancosu, M., Vezzoni, C. (2018). Local and national effects in the electoral cycle: the case of Italy (2001–2009). Territory, Politics, Governance, 6(3), 381–399.

[12] Mancosu, M., Vezzoni, C. (2018). Actor-partner interdependence models (APIM) and voting behavior: Methodology and applications. Political Psychology, 39(1), 163–176.

[11] Mancosu, M.. (2018). The deep roots of populism: Protest, apathy and the success of Movimento 5 Stelle in the 2013 Italian Elections. Italian Political Science, 13(3), 44–60.

[10] Mancosu, M.. (2018). Populism, emotionalized blame attribution and selective exposure in social media. A comparative analysis of Italy and UK. Comunicazione Politica, 19(1), 73–92.

[9] Bobba, G., Cremonesi, C., Mancosu, M., Seddone, A. (2018). Populism and the gender gap: Comparing digital engagement with populist and non-populist Facebook pages in France, Italy, and Spain. The International Journal of Press/Politics, 23(4), 458–475.

[8] Ladini, R., Mancosu, M., Vezzoni, C. (2017). Hai veramente letto la domanda? Valutazione della qualità delle risposte nelle survey online attraverso domande screener. Giornale Italiano Di Psicologia, 44(4), 973-992.

[7] Mancosu, M., Vezzoni, C. (2017). "Blood Is Thicker Than Water": interpersonal influence, selection, and the role of family in forging italians' political agreement. International Journal of Communication, 11, 22.

[6] Mancosu, M. (2017). Interpersonal communication, voting behaviour and influence in an election campaign: The 2009 German elections. Austrian Journal of Political Science. 46(3): 33-43.

[5] Mancosu, M., Vassallo, S., Vezzoni, C. (2017). Believing in conspiracy theories: Evidence from an exploratory analysis of Italian survey data. South European Society and Politics, 22(3), 327–344.

[4] Mancosu, M.. (2016). Contexts, networks, and voting behavior: The social flow of political communication in Italy. Italian Political Science Review/Rivista Italiana Di Scienza Politica, 46(3), 335–354.

[3] Vezzoni, C., Mancosu, M. (2016). Diffusion processes and discussion networks: An analysis of the propensity to vote for the 5 Star Movement in the 2013 Italian election. Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties, 26(1), 1–21.

[2] Guetto, R., Mancosu, M., Scherer, S., Torricelli, G. (2016). The spreading of cohabitation as a diffusion process: Evidence from Italy. European Journal of Population, 32, 661–686.

[1] Mancosu, M.. (2014). Geographical context, interest in politics and voting behaviour: the case of the Northern League in Italy. Contemporary Italian Politics, 6(2), 131–146.

Book chapters

[7] Vegetti, F., Mancosu, M. (2025) La relazione tra populismo e teorie del complotto, in Zulianello, M, Guasti, P. (eds.) Capire il populismo. UTET.

[6] Barbera, F., Mancosu, M., Tomnyuk, V., Varavallo, G. (2024) L'accoglienza dei rifugiati extraeuropei e ucraini in Italia. In F. Barbera (ed.) La solidarietà discreta. L'accoglienza dei profughi ucraini in Italia e in Europa, 73-91. Roma. Donzelli.

[5] Mancosu, M. (2023). I luoghi del consenso per i partiti maggiori. In Vassallo, S. Verzichelli, L. Il bipolarismo asimmetrico. L'Italia al voto dopo il decennio populista, Bologna, Il Mulino.

[4] Legnante, G. Mancosu, M. Vaccari, C. (2023). I consumi informativi degli elettori tra media tradizionali e internet: uno sguardo diacronico. In Roncarolo, F., Vezzoni, C. Svolta a destra? Cosa ci dice il voto del 2022. Bologna, Il Mulino.

[3] Seddone, A., Bobba, G., Mancosu, M., Vegetti, F., (2022). C come cospirazione. Attitudini populiste e teorie del complotto ai tempi del covid. In Dalla pandemia all'infodemia. La disinformazione ai tempi del Covid-19 (pp. 17–29). Feltrinelli.

[2] Barbera, F., Mancosu, M. (2016). Isole nell'isola. Il microcredito come processo di imitazione e apprendimento localizzato. In L'isola che c'è. Microcredito e azione pubblica in Sardegna (pp. 133–158). Egea.

[1] Mancosu, M.. (2015). La pista nera. Il successo della Lega in Toscana e l'eredità del Msi. In Dopo la luna di miele. Le elezioni comunali e regionali fra autunno 2014 e primavera 2015 (pp. 271–276). CISE.

Books

[1] Mancosu, M.. (2018). Contexts, networks, and the vote. An analysis of environmental effects on electoral behavior in Italy. Rome. Aracne.